time had it really been bad. Homesickness and frustration were all I suffered, and if I could have avoided those, I might even have had a rather good time.

I took the train back to New York and called up Gertrude as soon as I got into the station. She said, "Go to a hotel."

I said, "What!"

Apparently she had had a small cyst removed from one of her lower eyelids and the operation had produced a black eye and she didn't want me seeing her like that.

What nonsense! I refused to go to any hotel unless she went with me, and by 11:30 p.m. I was with her. I had made my anniversary by half an hour, and that anniversary was the happiest one I spent with her.

On Sunday the twenty-eighth I took the train to Windsor Place. I was in civilian clothes again (hurrah) and at the station, and an Army major inadvertently stepped on my foot.

"Pardon me," he said, automatically.

I waved a lordly hand, "That's all right, bub," I said, and with that, I knew I was out of the Army.

PART V

Into and out of tAanhattan

Dean Street

On the twenty-ninth, I went to Columbia and arranged for my return. There was no question but that my status there was perfectly regular, and in September 1946 I would register and begin research.

Meanwhile, the month of August had to be spent largely in apartment hunting, and that wasn't easy. Now that the war was over, everybody wanted an apartment, and during the war years, none had been built. They were very scarce and, in consequence, very expensive. The apartments that Columbia was building in Nyack had been slowed by labor problems, wouldn't be ready for quite a while and, when we went to look at them, we found that they were not at all suitable.